

A Rock Band Gets Ready for Its 100th Show at a Famous Arena

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The rock band Phish will soon play its 100th **concert** at Madison Square Garden. That is a famous **arena** in New York City. The big show will be on January 2. It will end four nights of **concerts** around New Year's Eve.

Phish first played there in 1994. In 2017, the band played 13 shows in a row there. During those shows, it played 237 songs without repeating a single one!

To celebrate, Phish made a video with people who work at the **arena**. **Ushers**, bartenders and food sellers shared their memories. "I love the Phish," one worker says. The video also shows the relaxed, swaying way Phish fans like to dance.

Tickets for the New York shows go on sale on October 16. Later, in late January, the band will play at its own **festival** in Cancún, Mexico.

Word Treasure

arena -- A big building with lots of seats for concerts or sports.

concert -- A show where musicians play music for an audience.

Ushers -- Workers who help people find their seats.

festival -- A big celebration, often with music and lots of people.

Background you need

Madison Square Garden is a famous arena in New York City where bands play and sports teams compete.

Playing 100 shows in one place is a big deal because many different performers want to play there.

Break it down

WHO: The rock band Phish and the workers at Madison Square Garden

WHAT: Phish will play its 100th concert at the arena

WHERE: Madison Square Garden in New York City

WHY: To celebrate a big milestone after many years of shows there

Why it matters

It shows that doing something you love again and again, with friends and fans, can lead to a big milestone.

Test what you remember

1. What kind of band is Phish?

- ☐ (A) A rock band
- ☐ (B) A marching band
- ☐ (C) A school band
- ☐ (D) A cartoon band

2. When will Phish play its 100th show at Madison Square Garden?

- ☐ (A) January 2
- ☐ (B) December 25
- ☐ (C) October 16
- ☐ (D) July 4

3. When did Phish first play at the Garden?

- ☐ (A) 2017
- ☐ (B) 2026
- ☐ (C) 1994
- ☐ (D) 1950

4. How many songs did Phish play in 2017 without repeating one?

- ☐ (A) 13
- ☐ (B) 4
- ☐ (C) 237
- ☐ (D) 100

5. Who is in Phish's celebration video?

- ☐ (A) Zoo animals
- ☐ (B) Famous athletes
- ☐ (C) Only the band
- ☐ (D) People who work at the arena

6. Where will the band play its own festival?

- ☐ (A) London, England
- ☐ (B) Cancún, Mexico
- ☐ (C) Tokyo, Japan
- ☐ (D) Paris, France

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: C 4: C 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):